it was Kamran’s.

For the next seven years, these two older sons of Babur would be locked in seemingly endless and increasingly bloody tussles over the city in which their father was buried. The fault of this is often laid at Babur’s feet; Abul Fazl suggests more than once that it was Babur who dinned an endless clemency for his brothers into Humayun’s head, thus making it impossible for his eldest son to take definitive action against his insubordinate siblings.

It is true that Babur once wrote to Humayun, ‘Conduct yourself well with your younger brother [Kamran]. Elder brothers need to have restraint.’
It is equally true, however, that in the lines immediately preceding this advice, Babur also wrote, ‘You know that this rule has always been observed: six parts to you and five to Kamran. Always observe this rule and do not break it.’[37]

Now, when all that remained of Babur’s bequest was Kamran’s share, Kabul and Qandahar, and when it was Humayun, after all, who had lost the rest of it, was it not breaking Babur’s rule to take Kamran’s cities away from him? Certainly, Humayun knew that he did not possess the unquestioning approval of his kin; and he wasn’t shy of suppressing their dissent. All through those seventeen days of celebration in Kabul, for example, Askari was kept in prison. Soon afterwards, their cousin Yadgar Nasir, recently returned to the fold, was found plotting rebellion again. Humayun had him killed. The impatient young man who had whipped Askari into action against plundering mobs was strangled with a bowstring. Then, Humayun went marching north to his old fief, Badakhshan, where Sulaiman was showing a Kamran-like disinclination to give up his land to his stateless cousin.

Humayun had a successful campaign in Badakhshan. Sulaiman fled the battlefield, and Humayun followed his success further north, so energetically that the northern kingdom of Turan was in ‘dismay’,[38] wondering if Babur’s son would make a bid for its capital and the city of Babur’s dreams: Samarqand.

As it happened, however, Humayun fell ill; and while he recovered soon enough, news of his ill health travelled as quickly to Kamran. The dispossessed younger brother had not been idle these past months: he had forged himself an alliance with Sindh by marrying the daughter of Shah